

Wild cats

Sleek, stealthy, patient, and intelligent, wild cats are natural killers. Most of them hunt on their own, using their claws and teeth to catch, stab, and cut up their prey. They are athletic, with supple, muscular bodies that are well adapted to running, climbing, leaping, and even swimming. They live in various habitats across Africa, Asia, Europe, and the Americas.

CONSERVATION

The threats to wild cats vary according to where they live, but the main ones are poaching and the loss of their habitat. Most of the big cats are now vulnerable or endangered.

- KEY**
- Critically endangered
 - Endangered
 - Vulnerable
 - Near threatened
 - Least concern

AMUR LEOPARD	BENGAL TIGER	INDOCHINESE CLOUDED LEOPARD
SNOW LEOPARD	AMUR TIGER	DIARD'S CLOUDED LEOPARD
ASIATIC LION	AFRICAN LION	JAGUAR

SMALL WILD CATS

More than three-quarters of the world's wild cats are classified as "small". The 30 different species have adapted to their environments – their colours help them blend in. Domestic cats were derived from the North African wildcat.



SERVAL



GEOFFROY'S CAT



IBERIAN LYNX



EUROPEAN WILDCAT



EURASIAN LYNX



FISHING CAT



COLOCOLO



CARACAL

BIG CATS

Lions, tigers, jaguars, and leopards are classed as cats. They all live alone, except for lions, which live in a big group known as a pride. The largest cats in the world are the Bengal and Amur tigers, which can weigh the same as 100 domestic cats.



LION



LIONESS



CLOUDED LEOPARD